

JIYOUNG KIM

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Placement Directors

Prof. Rui Castro	rui.castro@mcgill.ca	(514) 398-1226
Prof. Kensuke Sakamoto	kensuke.sakamoto@mcgill.ca	

Education

Ph.D. Economics <i>expected 2027</i>	McGill University <i>Fall 2021–</i>
M.A. Economics	Yonsei University <i>Mar 2019–Feb 2021</i>
B.A. Quantitative Risk Management and Economics	Yonsei University <i>Mar 2014–Aug 2018</i>

Fields of Specialization

Primary: Macroeconomics
Secondary: Labor Economics

Dissertation

Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics
Supervisors: Prof. Rui Castro, Prof. Markus Poschke

Job Market Paper

“Firm-level Workforce Composition and Firm Dynamics”

Using Canadian employer–employee matched data, this paper shows the importance of workforce quality for firms’ productivity and performance. By looking at how firms adjust their workforce composition over the life-cycle, I document how initial workforce quality shapes a firm’s future. Firms start with a small but high-quality workforce, then expand with lower-quality workers, diluting workforce quality. While firms share this trend, longer surviving firms maintain a better workforce than those that exit earlier. To explain the findings, I develop a firm dynamics model with endogenous productivity growth and choice over the mix of heterogeneous workers. Among the workers, only some high-quality workers, ‘leaders’, have the capability to build organizational capital, an intangible asset that raises productivity. As firms enter with little organizational capital, leaders are most needed when firms are young. Once enough organizational capital is accumulated, firms scale up with the lower-quality ‘regular workers’, who produce based on the foundation the leaders have laid. I use the calibrated model to quantify the importance of leaders for the aggregate economy. I find that a 1% increase in the wage of leaders lowers long-run aggregate productivity by 0.6%. The wage increase hits young firms hardest, depriving them of the opportunity to accumulate organizational capital. The forgone initial accumulation compounds into a permanent loss in firm-level productivity and accounts for 80% of the long-run aggregate productivity loss.

Other Research Papers

- “[Predicting Labor Force Types](#)”, NBER Working Paper No. 35295, with Castro, Lange, Larivière and Poschke
- “Labour Force Histories”, work in progress, with with Castro, Lange, and Poschke

Teaching Experience

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| • Teaching Assistant, Econ 354: Macroeconomics — Honours 2, McGill University | 2026 W |
| • Teaching Assistant, Econ 450: Advanced Economic Theory 1, McGill University | 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026 W; 2026 F |
| • Teaching Assistant, Econ 713: Macroeconomic Theory 2, McGill University | 2025 W |
| • Teaching Assistant, Econ 209: Macroeconomic Analysis & Applications, McGill University | 2025 Summer, 2025 F |
| • Teaching Assistant, Econ 332: Macroeconomic Theory — Majors 1, McGill University | 2024 F |
| • Teaching Assistant, Econ 208: Microeconomic Analysis & Applications, McGill University | 2022 F |

Research and Relevant Work Experience

Research Assistant	Korea Development Institute (KDI)
<i>Knowledge Sharing Program (KSP)</i>	<i>Aug 2014–Apr 2016</i>
• Economic policy consulting program with the Government of Belize	

Conference and Seminar Presentations

• T2M Student Workshop Program, HEC Montreal	June 2026
• Canadian Economics Association, Simon Fraser University	May 2026
• 20th CIREQ–CIRANO PhD Students’ Conference, CIRANO Montreal	May 2026
• 19th QICSS Emerging Excellence Conference, INRS (<i>Best presentation award</i>)	April 2026
• CIREQ Lunch Seminar, McGill University	November 2025; Aug 2026
• Canadian Economics Association, Toronto Metropolitan University	May 2024

Languages

Korean (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced)

Computational Skills

Python, MATLAB, Stata, TensorFlow, Keras
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References

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Prof. Markus Poschke	McGill University	<u>markus.poschke@mcgill.ca</u>	(514) 398-1233